After leaving Los Angeles, Nancy and I spent almost two weeks at the ranch, a summer vacation that was the longest uninterrupted time we'd ever spent there. The weather was terrific except for one foggy day, but even that day we had our regular morning ride and I spent every afternoon pruning trees and fixing things around the ranch.

At the time, the papers were full of reports that I was planning to raise taxes if reelected. "They find every excuse to say I'm really hedging," I wrote in my diary one day. "Well d—m it, there will be no new taxes on my watch and Mondale is stuck with his campaign promise to raise the income tax."

After George Bush and I were nominated a second time amid a tumultuous celebration in Dallas, I said in my acceptance speech that voters had their clearest choice between the two national parties in fifty years: Despite the Democrats' attempts to change their tune during their four days beside San Francisco Bay, the choice was between a government of "pessimism, fear, and limits and [one] of hope, confidence, and growth." After the speech, Ray Charles sang "America the Beautiful" and I don't think there was a dry eye in the house.

I believe that someday we are going to have a woman president, possibly during my life, and I've often thought the best way to pave the way for this was to first nominate and elect a woman as vice-president. But I think Mondale made a serious mistake when he picked Geraldine Ferraro as his running mate. In my view, he guessed wrong in deciding to take a congresswoman that almost nobody had ever heard of and try to put her in line for the presidency. We have had many successful woman governors around the country who have demonstrated the potential to serve as president, but he overlooked them. I think if the Republicans had done this with a Jeane Kirkpatrick (our UN representative), for example, there would have been a lot more sense to it. I